

water," says the Chief Minister.

Such farmers as grow crops other than paddy on at least 50 percent of their paddy area last year by growing alternate crops such as maize, cotton, bajra and pulses, are provided Rs. 7,000 per acre as incentive. They are not permitted to cultivate paddy in any new areas where paddy was not grown during the last year. Farmers operating tube wells with 50HP electric motors are not allowed to grow paddy.

In order to further incentivise the farmers, the Manohar Lal Government has decided that all diversified crops such as maize, bajra and pulses will be procured at the MSP. Not only this, the Government has also promised to provide 85 percent subsidy for the installation of drip irrigation system in the alternate diversified crops.

Promoting micro irrigation

Micro irrigation is being promoted. The State Government bears 85 percent of the expenditure on auxiliary infrastructure while farmers have to pay only 15 percent of the cost. This year, Rs. 1,214 crore has been proposed as subsidy under Per Drop More Crop component of Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY).

While steps are being taken to enable the farmers conserve water, avenues are being explored to make more water available for irrigation. For enhancing capacity of the canal network, construction of new Parallel Lined Channel and remodelling of the Western Yamuna Canal, Augmentation Canal, Parallel Delhi Branch, Hansi Branch, Jawaharlal Nehru Canal have been started.

The State Government also plans to improve capacity and efficiency of pumping machinery of the lift irrigation system in Rewari, Mahendragarh, Charkhi Dadri and Bhiwani districts.

In order to meet the drinking water needs for Nuh and Gurugram districts, the Government has decided to construct Mewat Feeder Canal of 200 cusecs capacity and also undertake remodelling of Gurgaon Water Supply (GWS) Channel with capacity of 475 cusecs from the existing capacity of 175 cusecs.



Reusing waste water

Water conservation will lose meaning if we do not prepare ourselves to treat and use waste water. Policy changes have been made to encourage its use by power plants, industries, irrigation and municipalities for non-drinking purposes to ensure that fresh water resources are conserved.

Sewerage treatment plants and common effluent treatment plants have been set up to generate 1,967 MLD of treated waste water. The recommendations of the Haryana Water Resources Authority on the tariff for use of treated wastewater and the sectors where its use can be mandated are expected shortly.

Check Dams being set up

Inspired by the Prime Minister's remark that "when clouds rain, they rain not only for us but also for the generations to come", the Manohar lal Government has taken several initiatives to harness the rain water.

The Shivalik Hills in the northern part and Aravalli Hills in southern Haryana constitute major watersheds. A number of water springs and small creeks exist in these hills which carry water during monsoon. To conserve and utilise water run-off, check dams have been planned in Shivalik Hills and Aravalli Hills.

Continuous efforts are being made for the construction of upstream storage dams on Renuka, Kishau and Lakhwar Vyasi tributaries of river Yamuna for improving water supply. The Prime Minister laid the foundation stone of the Renuka Dam in December last year. The total storage capacity of these check dams will be about 37.36 million cubic metres (MCM).

With a view to recharging the ground water with rain water, 1,000 recharging bore wells and shafts are being constructed at a cost of Rs. 39.66 crore. Target has been set to construct 5,000 recharge bore wells in 2022-23.

Simultaneously, the State Government has successfully implemented Atal Bhujal Yojana to